

HP EliteBook X G2i 14

Small size, serious performance

Business laptops don't usually get the same attention as gaming laptops or sleek ultrabooks. In fact, a lot of people don't think twice before buying one. After all, most working professionals need their laptops to open a few spreadsheets, attend some meetings, reply to emails, and call it a day. But those who spend eight or even ten hours working on a laptop every day know that this is far from the truth. Your work laptop is actually one of the most important devices you own.

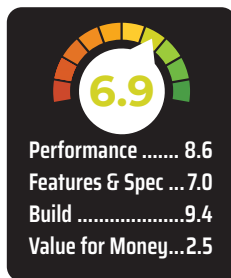
With a starting price of Rs 2.5 lakh, the EliteBook X G2i 14 is HP's premium business laptop that comes with a strong performance, all-day battery life, enterprise-grade features, and a lightweight design that's easy to carry around. I've been using it as my primary work machine for over a week, and while it gets a lot of things right, there are some tiny hiccups. Curious to know more? Read on.

DESIGN AND BUILD

The first thing I noticed about the EliteBook X G2i is, of course, the design. HP has played things extremely safe when it comes to the laptop's looks. The device, without a doubt, looks professional but also generic. At this price point, I expected something that felt a little more special. More colour options (apart from the Eclipse Grey, Atmospheric Blue, and Glacier Silver) or a more distinctive design language could have helped the EliteBook stand out from the crowd.

The one thing that impressed me about the EliteBook X G2i was its weight. We all know that business users are constantly moving between desks,

₹2,50,000



meeting rooms and offices. And if the job involves travel, there are numerous trips to even airports and hotels. In all of these cases, a laptop's weight, as well as form factor, matters. The HP EliteBook X G2i 14 is a relatively compact and lightweight device that doesn't compromise on durability. Throughout my testing, it never felt like a burden in my backpack or my arms, even after a full day of running around while carrying it.

Coming to the build quality, there isn't much to complain about. The laptop overall feels reassuringly sturdy and well-built when you hold it in your hand. The keyboard deck remains solid under pressure and gives the laptop a premium feel. That said, there surely is a small amount of flex on the lid if you deliberately press down on it, but nothing that raises concerns during daily use.

One feature I want to mention here is the 180-degree hinge. And this is incredibly thoughtful on HP's part. Let me explain why.

Even though this sounds like a minor feature, being able to lay the display completely flat can be useful during collaborative discussions in a meeting room or while sharing content with colleagues sitting across the table.

DISPLAY

If there is one area where the EliteBook X G2i left me wanting more, it is the display. But before I say anything else, let's get one thing out of the way: this is not a bad screen. The 14-inch touchscreen panel gets bright enough for indoor and outdoor use, colours look decent, and text remains sharp. So for usual day-to-day office work, the display performs well.

But the problem arises when you look at that price tag. At over Rs 2.5 lakh, expectations naturally increase. And the IPS panel simply lacks the vibrancy and contrast that many competing premium laptops now offer. The content looks good, but it is not really that impressive.

Moreover, HP's integrated privacy screen technology brings with it some viewing-angle quirks. Depending on how you position the display, colours can shift slightly, making the image appear inconsistent. And then there's the refresh rate, which is limited to 60Hz, and it feels somewhat dated in 2026. Granted, your productivity won't be affected here because of this, but it is still something worth mentioning.

KEYBOARD AND TRACKPAD

As someone who spends most of the day writing, I immediately notice the typing experience on any device. And the EliteBook X G2i 14 scores full marks in this department.

The keys have a smooth and tactile feel that makes long writing sessions comfortable, and there is enough travel to provide satisfying feedback. In addition to this, the spacious keyboard deck gives your palms plenty of room to rest.

Even the touchpad has haptic feedback, which takes things up a notch